

Scenario

Monster of the Week — Session 2 Prep

GAME2102 · Bow Valley College · Feb 2026 · Instructor: Yash | Session Keeper: Michael

Part 2: Prepare Dynamic Potential

Opening Situation

The hunters have just finished a confrontation with a ghoul in the sewers. When the ghoul falls, they notice a **sigil branded onto the back of both of its hands**. Viper visibly flinches at the sight of it, then quickly schools his expression. He is not as surprised as he should be.

Viper makes a decision: he cuts the branded flesh from the ghoul's hands. Eilian takes the pieces and uses them to investigate the ghoul's lair and what is discovered is quite odd. **Before the hunters ever confronted the ghoul, it had been pressing its hand against the back wall, muttering.** It was performing some kind of long-distance communication spell. During the investigation, Eilian catches a flash of *metal and circuitry* as a concept, not a location. Someone, or something, may already be aware of the hunters.

Yahya picks up Abu's jacket, which the ghoul was carrying, something unexpected happens: holding it allows him to see a vivid **aura afterglow trail**, but only while he is holding it. When the group exits the sewers, the trail leads in the *opposite direction* from the way they came in.

After a discussion about how to proceed next, the group decides to return to town. The group consults with a colleague of Eilian's at W.I.T.C.H. headquarters, combining everything they have found. The consultation points them toward an old junkyard some distance away from town and towards the nearby mountains.

Active Threats

1. Steve 'The Janky'

Type: Destroyer | **Size:** 7' Large | **Appearance:** Human-passing, appears to be a man in his 40s with a fixation on Transformers

Motivation: Build an army. His obsession with anything mechanical bleeds into how he thinks about power and loyalty. Everything is replaceable, everything can be made bigger.

Powers: Shapeshifting, Illusions, Create Minions (animates junk into Junk Golems).

Weakness: Gold. Physical contact burns him (0-harm), causing visible distress.

Attack: "Random Bullshit GO" : grabs and hurls anything within reach. 3-harm, area.

Warning Signs / Escalating Events:

- Xanthan is encountered in the abandoned general store, on the way to the junkyard
- Junk Golems are seen moving between the junkyard and the edge of town.
- Locals report tools and scrap metal going missing overnight.

- A circle of crushed vehicles forms around the junkyard's Northern area, making a ritual space.
- Abu is seen bound near the altar inside the junkyard.

Worst-Case Outcome: Steve completes the sacrifice. He receives magical power from his Dark Lord and becomes a genuine supernatural threat. His golem army grows, and his ambitions grow, dragging the hunters into a much larger conflict.

2. Junk Golems

Type: Guardian (Steve's minions) | **Size:** 3' Large

Motivation: Protect Steve. They have no agenda of their own — purely animated constructs.

Powers: When destroyed, a Junk Golem can attempt to merge with the remains of another nearby fallen golem, forming a larger composite creature.

Weakness: Water. Significant exposure permanently solidifies a golem, rendering it inert. Even a splash slows them down.

Attack: Smash. 1-harm, hand range.

Harm Capacity: 4 boxes, no armour. Weak individually, dangerous in numbers or if left to combine.

Worst-Case Outcome: Enough golems are destroyed in proximity that they merge into a single large composite creature, making a straightforward fight dramatically harder mid-session.

3. Xanthan

Type: Scout | **Form:** Mechanical Flying Praying Mantis | **Size:** 0.5' Large

Motivation: Keep watch and report back to Steve. Surveillance, not a combatant.

Powers: Flight and semi-transparency (near-invisible when stationary).

Weakness: Has a sweet tooth, and will switch sides for food. Offer him candy, computer chips, or sugar and he will abandon his current master and join whoever feeds him.

Attacks: None.

Harm Capacity: Cannot die.

Session Outcome: The hunters encountered Xanthan at the abandoned general store on the road to the junkyard. He was successfully recruited, albeit only after Ellian unleashed his inner murderhobo. Turns out, Ellian really, really doesn't like bugs.

Key NPCs

Unused Prep: Marty & Tyrell

Two bystanders were prepared for this session but did not appear due to pacing and time constraints. **Marty** was a hippie living in a treehouse between the junkyard and the sewer, and had witnessed the ghoul's movements. **Tyrell** was a man with terminal cancer whose motivation involved ensuring a life insurance payout reached his family. Both remain available as material for future sessions.

Abu (Yahya's Brother)

Type: Captive / Rescue Target

Motivation: Survive. Abu was kidnapped along with Yahya and Oscar's families and has been held by Steve as a ritual component.

Personality: Disoriented from captivity but observant. May have noticed details about Steve's operation that are useful to the hunters.

Signature Detail: His jacket is the source of the aura trail Yahya is following.

Key Locations

1. The Junkyard

Type: Lair / Den

Atmosphere: Towers of compressed scrap and rust loom in the dark like crooked teeth. The smell of chemical solvents hangs in the air — Steve has been here long enough that the ground itself feels wrong. Shadows move between the piles. Some of those shadows have eyes.

Dangers:

- Junk Golems patrol the inner perimeter. Slow but relentless.
- Unstable stacks of scrap can collapse if disturbed, difficult terrain throughout.
- Steve is somewhere in the interior, aware and territorial.
- An improvised altar has been constructed at one end of the junkyard.

Opportunities:

- Water sources (pipes, tanks) are present — useful against the golems.
- Abu is held near the altar and is visible once hunters push deep enough in.

Notes: Steve has been gaining power through prolonged chemical exposure on this site. The junkyard is becoming an extension of his will. This is his home turf.

2. The Abandoned General Store

Type: Crossroads / Staging Point

Atmosphere: A weathered building at the road turnoff toward the junkyard. Boarded windows, faded signage, unlocked door. The shelves inside are dusty but not entirely empty.

Dangers:

- Isolated location — if the hunters are followed here, there is no one nearby to help.

Opportunities:

- Old stock may include useful supplies — salt, tools, rope, cleaning products.
- A hidden compartment beneath one of the shelving units contains something of use (Keeper's discretion).
- Good staging ground or fallback point before pushing into the junkyard.

Session Note: This is where Xanthan was encountered and recruited. The store functioned as a natural pause point before the final approach.

Stakes Questions

- Will Yahya find Abu in time, or will the ritual complete before they can act?
- What does Viper actually know about the sigil, and when will he tell the others?
- Do Steve's plans include wanting to overthrow his own Dark Lord, therefore making him an ally of sorts?